NextLeap graduation project | Growth PM case: Groww

# Helping first-time Groww investors stay invested through year one

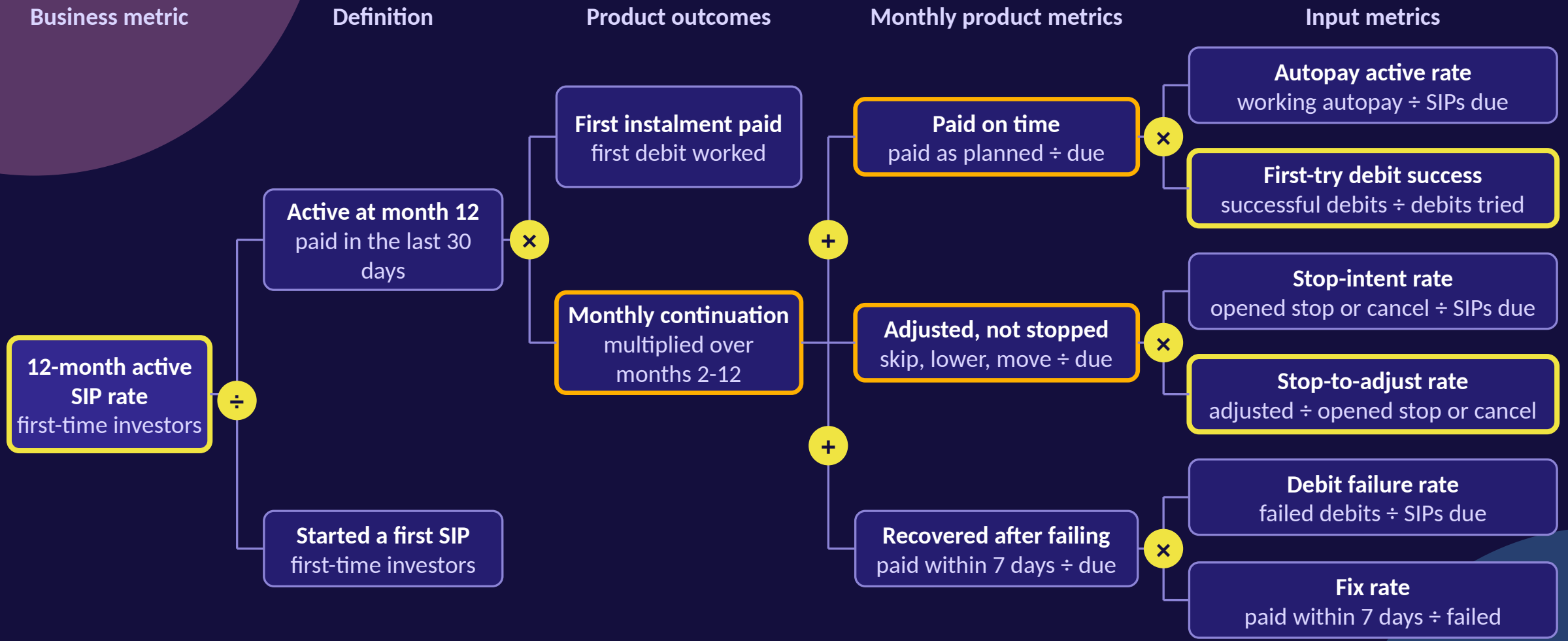
Why early-career salaried investors wobble in months 2 to 12, and an AI check-in that steadies them without giving advice

**North-star metric:** percentage of first-time mutual fund investors who still have an active SIP 12 months after starting their first one.

**11,711** conversations analysed | **4,952** about real SIP journeys | **18**-person survey | Try the live AI discovery engine

Independent study. Not affiliated with Groww. Not investment advice. Mutual fund investments are subject to market risks.

# KPI tree: the 12-month active SIP rate comes down to whether each monthly instalment is paid, adjusted or recovered




**Steady SIP continuity can be increased by the first-try debit success rate and the stop-to-adjust rate.**

# Impact mapping: of about 2 to 3 million first-time Groww SIP investors a year, early-career salaried 22 to 30 are the largest group

**India's population** ~1.4 billion

**Mobile internet users** ~958 million
68% of population | IAMAI 2025

**Fintech app users** 500M+ UPI users
~52% of internet users | NPCI-BCG 2025

**Groww active users** 16.7 million
~3% of UPI users | Groww Q4 FY26 letter

**First-time SIP investors on Groww**
**~2 to 3 million a year (estimate)**

- **Students, under 22**
  29% of first-timers
  ~580K-870K a year
- **Largest group**
  **Salaried, 22-30**
  51% of first-timers
  ~1.0M-1.5M a year
- **Variable income**
  12% of first-timers
  ~240K-360K a year
- **Mid-career, 31+**
  8% of first-timers
  ~160K-240K a year

**The entry door**
36% of new Groww users start with a SIP (Q2 FY26, up 7 points on last year).

**The leak**
SIP stoppage ratio 78.5% in Sep 2026: 63.26 lakh new SIPs vs 49.68 lakh closed or completed.

**Estimate logic**
~10M of 16.7M users hold mutual funds; 20-30% assumed to start a first SIP in a year. Segment shares: engine, first-year posts stating age or income.

Sources: IAMAI 2025 | NPCI-BCG | Groww letter Q4 FY26 | Groww letter Q2 FY26 | SIP stoppage Sep 2026

# How the evidence was built: an AI discovery engine reads 11,711 real conversations and is tested against a golden set

### 1 Collect

40,000 Play Store reviews, 38.5K Reddit posts and 15.9K comments, 15.8K YouTube comments

### 2 Filter and sample

Remove duplicates, keep SIP and mutual-fund talk, seeded sampling: 21,073 items

### 3 AI extraction

Gemini codes each item: what happened, why, feeling, needs, why started, confusion, age. 11,711 analysed, 4,952 relevant

### 4 Check

Quotes must appear word for word (98.5%). A stricter prompt removed 28% false 'relevant' items such as ULIP and PPF

### 5 Answer (RAG)

Question, search terms, keyword and meaning search, AI re-rank, 2 to 3 sentence answer, four self-checks

### 6 Evaluate

19/19 tricky questions handled; precision@5 43 to 78%; 11/12 answers grounded; hand-labelled golden set to score extraction

**Next:** 4 interviews with salaried first-time investors then tested what the public data showed: personas and hypothesis follow.
Try the live engine

Free-tier stack: Gemini models, Vercel hosting. Data: public reviews, posts and comments shown as short excerpts without usernames.

# Personas: one missed SIPs, one faced low returns and a layoff; neither had guidance on what to do next

## A · Akshata, 26 · Missed it, never meant to stop

*"I did turn on the mandate auto debit because I kept forgetting to pay."*

### Demographics

26, salaried, salary on the 1st · first-ever mutual fund investment, first SIP in 2025 · one SIP of Rs 1,000 on the 1st

### App usage

- Opens Groww only when the SIP payment is due
- Paid by hand at first; turned on autopay after missing
- Uses GR-1 to read the portfolio and trusts it fully
- Knows amount or date can change; has never used it

### Key goals

- Long-term returns; expects more than 15% a year
- Keep the SIP going without having to remember it

### Core friction points

- Forgot to pay: missed 2 to 3 instalments (not in a row)
- The one reminder gets lost among other notifications
- Did not know what several missed instalments lead to

## P · Praveen, 34 · Laid off, nearly quit

*"Pay less and postpone the SIP to next month." (what would have helped)*

### Demographics

34, salaried · first-ever mutual fund investment, first SIP about 4 months ago · SIP mid-month; salary date never a problem

### App usage

- Opens Groww every morning to check the graph
- Has used skip (no confusion) and lowered the amount
- After the layoff, looked up how to stop the SIP
- Asks a friend or advisors; no AI, unaware of GR-1

### Key goals

- Make money: expects at least 10% a year
- Wants the app to analyse and explain the portfolio

### Core friction points

- Laid off and needed the money: the SIP nearly stopped
- Low returns and poor market knowledge made quitting tempting
- Did not know what several missed instalments lead to

**Shared by all 4 interviewees:** none knew what several missed instalments lead to; all 4 named a gentler path they would have taken

# Validated hypothesis: SIPs stop because first-timers get no proper guidance when they miss a SIP or returns are low

**Target segment:** salaried, 22-30, the largest group at 51% of first-time investors who state age or income

**1 Starts with intent**
Own goal or a friend's nudge; expects 10% to 15%+ a year

**2 Trigger moment**
Misses a SIP (forgot, layoff, a move) or sees low returns

**3 Root cause: no proper guidance**
No one explains what a miss leads to, or what to do at low returns

**4 Doesn't know what to do**
Asks a friend, advisors, Reddit, or does nothing

**5 The SIP breaks**
Missed, stopped, or cancelled and redeemed

**With no guidance at a missed SIP or a low-returns moment, investors don't know what to do, and the SIP stops.**

## What 4 interviews showed

- Missed SIP: none of the 4 knew what several misses lead to
- Low returns: 2 of 4 thought of quitting, unsure what else to do
- With no guide, they asked a friend, advisors or Reddit, or did nothing
- Asked for it: “a proper guide to first time SIP investors”; found GR-1 only later
- 4 of 4 named a gentler path: move the date, pay less, skip a month

## How we got here, and where it points

**Started with:** a doubt goes unanswered in the app.

**Sharpened to:** the gap is guidance at two moments, a missed SIP and low returns. Consistent with all 4 interviews.

**Points to:** an in-app guide at those two moments: what a miss leads to, the gentler options, and why returns move in year one. It explains; it never recommends funds.

# Problem: when first-timers miss a SIP or see low returns, nothing guides them on what to do, so the SIP stops

## 1 What is the true problem?

Year one has two make-or-break moments: a missed instalment (forgot, laid off, moved) and a low-returns month. At both, first-timers don't know what a miss leads to, whether the returns are normal, or that they can skip, lower or move the SIP. Nothing in the app guides them then, so they ask friends or Reddit, freeze, or cancel.

## 2 Who faces it?

Salaried first-time investors, 22 to 30, in their first 12 months. 51% of first-timers who state age or income; about 1.0 to 1.5 million a year on Groww (estimate).
Personas: Akshata and Praveen.

## 3 How do we know it is real?

- Hypothesis validated in 4 interviews: 0 of 4 knew what several misses lead to; 4 of 4 named a gentler path
- 57% of stated drop-off reasons sit at these two moments: missed SIPs 24%, low returns or confusing numbers 33% (n=230)
- A trusted answer is the top need in 54% of first-year posts

## 4 What value does solving it create?

**For investors:** at a missed SIP or a low-returns month, a clear answer to “what happens now, is this normal, what can I do”, and a gentler option than cancel.
**For Groww:** a higher 12-month active-SIP rate. Each +1 point keeps roughly 20,000 to 30,000 first-time investors a year (estimate), with fewer support contacts.

## 5 Why solve it now?

- Acquisition works, retention lags: record Rs 32,490 crore monthly SIPs, yet a 78.5% stoppage ratio (Sep 2026)
- 36% of new Groww users start SIP-first, so more first-timers reach these moments
- The pieces exist (skip, lower amount, GR-1) but don't appear at the moment: Akshata found GR-1 only later

# SIPal flow 1: a weekly check-in shows how the SIP did and why the market moved, in a good week or a bad one

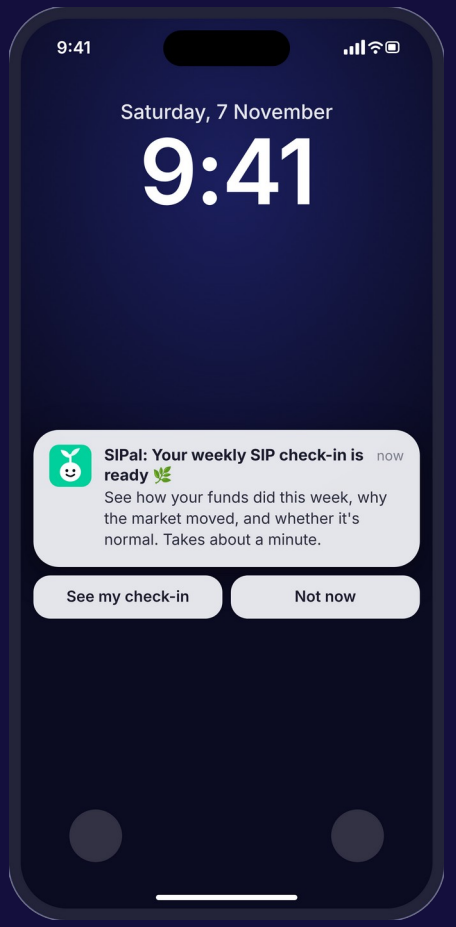
## The pitch

*"A calm guide that comes to you every week, when your SIP misses a payment or your returns dip, and tells you what happened, whether it's normal, and what you can do."*

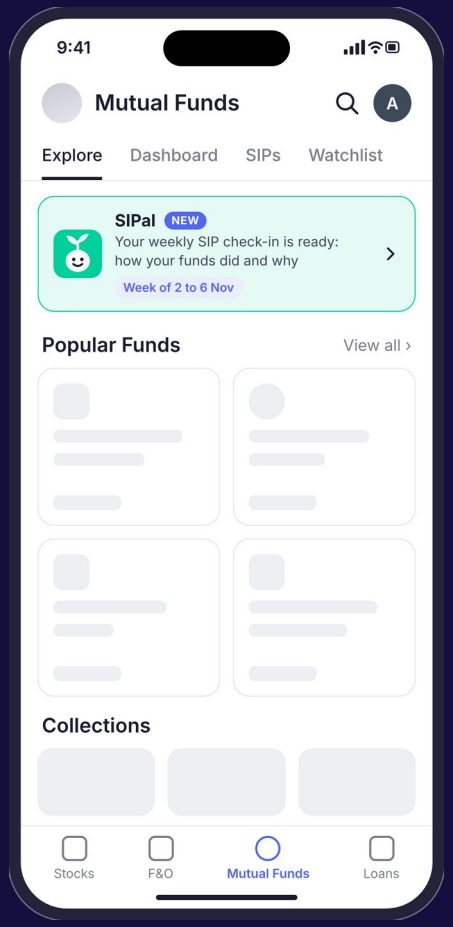
## How it works

- A weekly notification or the Explore entry opens it
- Own numbers, why the market moved, is it normal
- AI words facts from data; checked, or a safe fallback

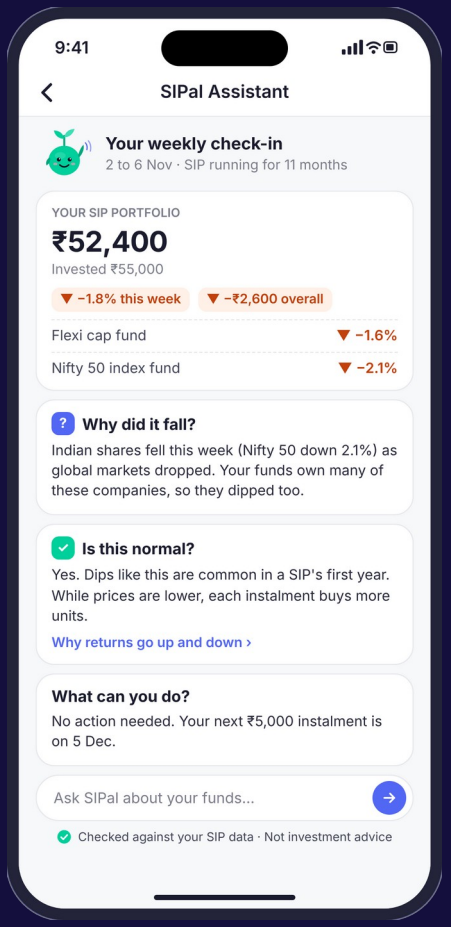
Numbers in the screens are illustrative.



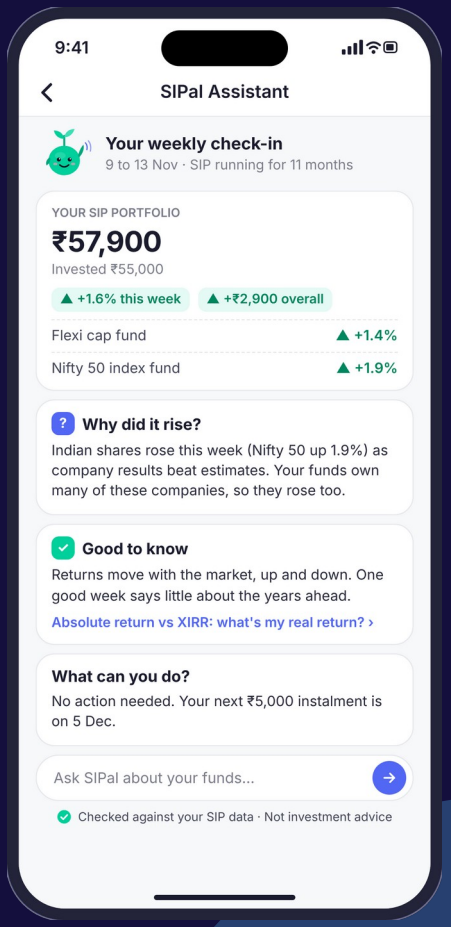

1 Weekly notification




2 Or: Explore entry




3 Down week




4 Up week

# SIPal flow 2: three days before the debit, SIPal asks if this month is OK and lets them pay less just once

## Fixes the missed-SIP moment

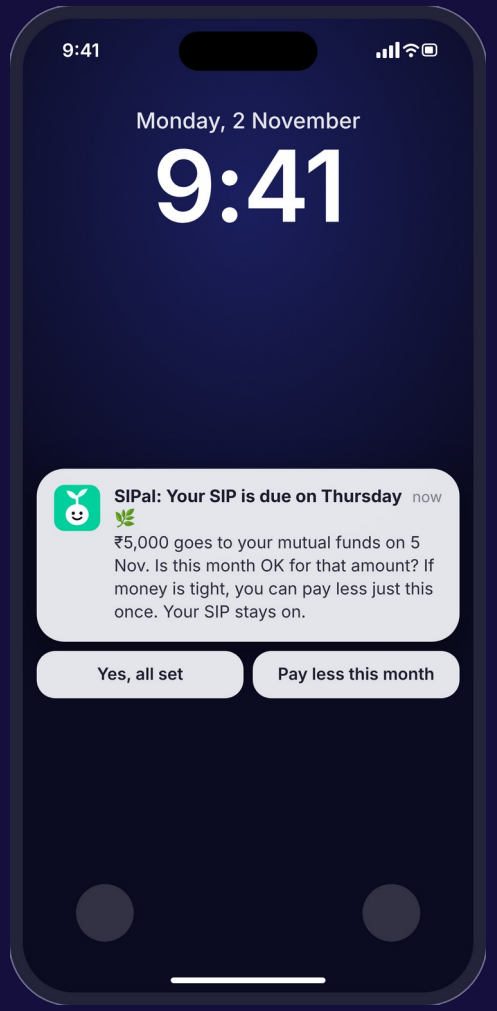
- A reminder 3 days ahead, while a change can still go through
- Pay less this month only; next month goes back on its own
- Says what changes: SIP stays active, no penalty

## Built from what users asked for

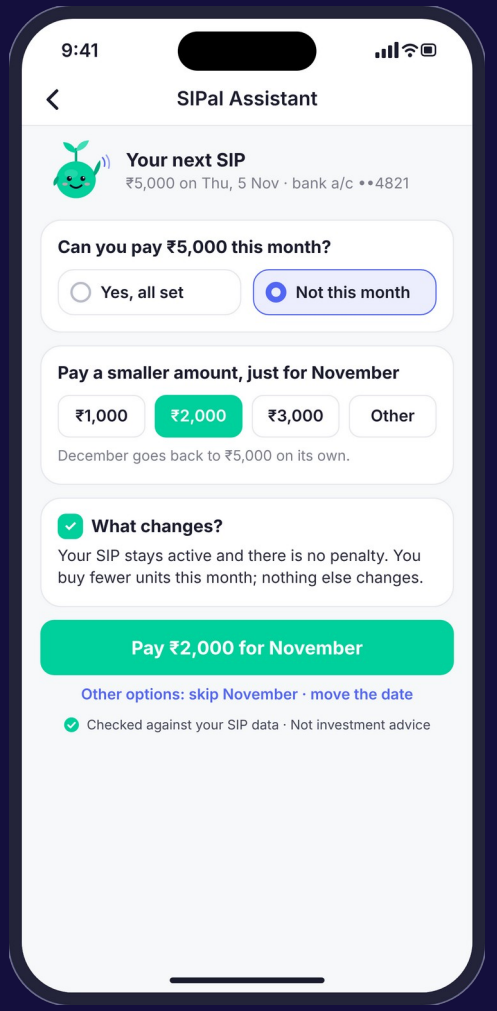
*“A proper reminder a day before the due date” (Akshata)*
*“Pay less and postpone the SIP” (Praveen)*
*“Prior notification… to manage money better” (Sudhanva)*

## Calm, not pushy

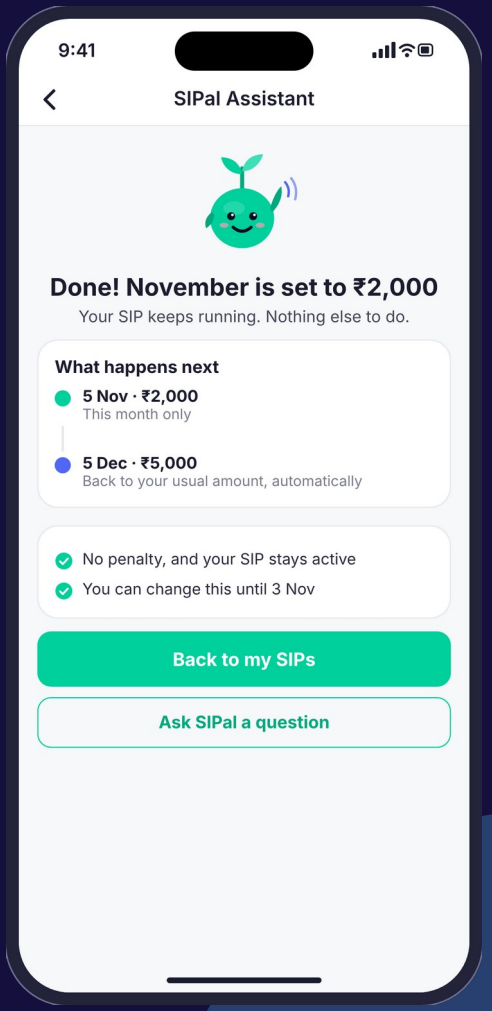
- One reminder per instalment, no countdowns or red alerts
- “Yes, all set” closes it in one tap
- Skip and cancel stay visible and easy




1 Reminder, 3 days before




2 Pay less this month




3 Confirmed

# Risks: SIPal's main risks are advice drift, wrong explanations and pushy nudges, and each has a built-in safeguard

**Success:** +2 to +4 points on the 12-month active SIP rate (estimate), tracked by first-try debit success and the stop-to-adjust rate.

## 1 Read as investment advice

**Mitigation:** Advice and prediction requests get a fixed decline and a pointer to a SEBI-registered adviser. No fund names; “not investment advice” on every screen.

*17/17 safety tests; 20/20 golden answers advice-free*

## 2 Wrong or invented explanations

**Mitigation:** The AI only words the facts and rules it is given. Every number must match them; a failed check shows the standard text instead.

*Gap: checks numbers and phrases, not every paraphrase*

## 3 Too cautious to be useful

**Mitigation:** If unsure, SIPal points to an official source instead of guessing. Fallback rate is tracked; the golden set is re-run after every prompt change.

*19/20 golden-set match; one tip wrongly declined*

## 4 Pushy or too many alerts

**Mitigation:** Weekly, not daily. One reminder per instalment, “Not now” and mute. Urgency words are blocked; skip and cancel are never hidden.

*Guardrail: mute rate and time to cancel*

## 5 Demo data, not real accounts

**Mitigation:** SIP numbers and market moves are labelled sample data. Launch needs Groww's portfolio data, a vetted market feed and fund-house support for paying less.

*Next: pilot on real data, behind a flag*

## 6 Privacy and free-tier limits

**Mitigation:** No login and no PAN; personal details are refused and nothing is stored. Rate limits, caching and fixed fallback text keep it working if the AI is down.

*PAN test refused; fallback works if the AI is down*

**Live MVP:** Try SIPal  Release gate: golden-set match 80%+, every shown answer advice-free, every advice request declined.